



"We are also planning to have a sports university here in the future," says Pramod Sawant, Chief Minister of Goa. THE HINDU PHOTO LIBRARY

CM Pramod Sawant: We're set to become a sports tourism destination as well

Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant addressed the gathering at Sportstar's first Conclave in 2024 in Goa virtually.

According to him, the state, otherwise known for being a major tourist destination in western India, is gradually turning into a sports hub. "Goa has been primarily known as a tourist destination, but it is set to become an epicentre of sports soon. Last year, Goa successfully hosted numerous national and international sporting events. Recently, under the guidance of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the National Games were held in Goa, which saw more than 10,000 athletes participate across 43 disciplines. Goa also achieved its highest medal tally of 92."

The CM thanked the Hon'ble Prime Minister for his contribution to sports. He said he shared Narendra Modi's dream of a 'Viksit Bharat 2047', the Government's vision to see India become a developed country by its 100th year of Independence.

"Modi ji's vision of Viksit Bharat 2047 will be inclusive of all. It is a part of Fit India, Skill India and Inclusive India. The role of sports in working towards the vision should also be discussed today (at the Conclave). Goa should also come to be known as a sports destination. We are known for hosting the IFFI International Film Festival, but we must keep in mind that the state has also successfully

hosted the Purple Festival, the WTT (Contender) event, and world beach volleyball. The government is also pushing for sports tourism, adventure tourism, and spiritual tourism. To establish the skills for these, we are also planning to have a sports university here in the future."

Goa's Tourism Minister: Integrating Sports for Multifaceted Development of State

The Goa government will promote sports tourism in the coastal State by expanding its vision, Tourism Minister Rohan Khaunte said. "We never spoke about sports tourism earlier. Sports was one department, tourism was another, technology was another department," Khaunte said.

"Goa is a preferred destination for your holidays. You come here to have a pleasant stay. When our government came in, we started talking about opportunities again. We are looking to go beyond beaches; we are using the hashtag #GoaBeyondBeaches. It is our responsibility to

relook at what we have been doing as states. Tourism is the chief economic driver for Goa, contributing approximately 16.43 per cent of the GDP and creating 30-35% of direct and indirect employment. This economical vertical can't be monotonous.

"COVID times made people think differently. People switched to working from home. Goa started being

